

Chapter 34-1

There was no one speaking in the room, only the sound of Yin Lingzhu flipping through the script.

President Yan's voice was small, but it still sounded very clear.

Yin Lingzhu heard the sound and shifted her gaze toward President Yan, but she only saw President Yan's back.

"What's wrong?" Yin Lingzhu couldn't see the situation, so she asked out loud.

At the same time, she looked at the floor beneath President Yan's feet—there were no water stains either.

It wasn't that water had spilled.

Yin Lingzhu put down the script and walked toward President Yan.

"Did you get burned?" Yin Lingzhu asked softly as she walked.

President Yan heard the footsteps and, for some unknown reason, suddenly became flustered.

"I, I didn't do it on purpose." President Yan said this sentence suddenly without thinking.

Yin Lingzhu looked at President Yan with amusement. When she got close to President Yan, she saw the bright red mark on the back of President Yan's hand.

"It's your own body—why are you apologizing to me?"

Seeing President Yan still standing there in a daze, she pulled President Yan into the bathroom.

She turned on the faucet and placed President Yan's hand under the running water.

When the cold water stimulated the injured area, President Yan's whole body shuddered, and she instinctively wanted to pull her hand back.

Yin Lingzhu gripped her wrist tightly, not letting her break free.

"Be good¹, it'll be better in a moment." President Yan's strength was very great, and she almost managed to break free. Yin Lingzhu could only speak to comfort her.

This sentence made both of them freeze for a moment. After Yin Lingzhu realized what she had said, she immediately let go of President Yan's hand.

Under the effect of the cold water, the swelling and pain from the burn on her hand gradually subsided.

"I just said that out of habit." Yin Lingzhu spoke up.

Why had she said that just now?

Yin Lingzhu silently cursed herself in her heart—why was she meddling in so many things?

"Just rinse it for a while longer, I'll leave first." Yin Lingzhu listened to the sound of running water, and her palm still seemed to retain the delicate sensation of touch.

She felt inexplicably irritated.

Without caring what President Yan said, she directly left the bathroom and walked toward the living room.

President Yan, left behind in the original spot, saw Yin Lingzhu's attitude toward her just now, and that sentence that seemed like scolding but was actually indulgent—her eyes grew brighter and brighter.

Yin Lingzhu sat back on the sofa and didn't continue looking at the script.

What she had just said was completely subconscious.

That fold-eared cat² from before—because it wasn't in good health, it was very delicate.

Every time Yin Lingzhu trimmed its nails, it was unwilling and would keep trying to pull its paws into its chest.

Yin Lingzhu had no choice and didn't dare to be too forceful with it, so she could only gently coax it with her words while speeding up with her hands.

President Yan just now was just like that fold-eared cat.

That's why she subconsciously said that sentence she always used to coax the cat.

When President Yan came out of the bathroom, it had already been quite a while.

The back of her hand was still red over a large area, looking very conspicuous.

When Yin Lingzhu saw it, she subconsciously wanted to ask President Yan why she didn't apply ointment.

She forcibly stopped herself from saying this—her behavior just now had already been somewhat excessive.

President Yan seemed to be deliberately showing her wound.

During the script explanation, all Yin Lingzhu could see was that shocking patch of red.

Every time Yin Lingzhu looked at President Yan suspiciously, President Yan would always meet her gaze, seeming to ask with her eyes, "What's wrong?"

At such times, Yin Lingzhu would shift her gaze away.

For the entire afternoon, Yin Lingzhu only reviewed the plot in the script once more—her acting skills hadn't improved in the slightest.

She somewhat suspected that President Yan was doing this on purpose.

When President Yan exposed the wound on the back of her hand yet again, Yin Lingzhu couldn't help but ask, "Are you unwilling to teach me?"

President Yan, who had originally wanted to gain sympathy, heard the slightly irritated tone in Yin Lingzhu's voice and froze.

"No, I didn't think that." President Yan said hurriedly, "I just..." want you to feel sorry for me.

President Yan's words stopped—she knew that saying the rest would only make Yin Lingzhu even angrier.

President Yan looked at Yin Lingzhu pitifully, "I just have a lot of pain in my hand, which might affect my performance when acting."

President Yan deliberately turned the back of her hand over, hiding it.

Yin Lingzhu looked at President Yan's eyes—the light brown pupils were filled with brokenness, like a lake into which a stone had been thrown.

Rippling outward circle by circle.

Yin Lingzhu suddenly felt that she might have wronged President Yan.

After all, the feeling of being burned was still very painful. When she first started learning to cook, she often burned her hands.

Although she couldn't figure out why hand pain would prevent acting, Yin Lingzhu still said "Oh."

"Then you should rest first. I won't trouble you anymore."

Yin Lingzhu looked at President Yan, returned the script to her, and walked toward the door.

Seeing her leave, President Yan hurriedly tried to keep her.

"But I've rested for an afternoon, and now I'm much better." President Yan said hastily.

To make her words more convincing, she pressed that patch on the back of her hand while speaking.

Even though the pain doubled, she still managed a smile.

Yin Lingzhu was still declining. Whenever she saw the wound on President Yan's hand, she thought of her own experience learning to cook for President Yan's sake.

"No, you should rest first. You still have scenes tomorrow." Yin Lingzhu smiled and left President Yan's room.

President Yan could tell that Yin Lingzhu had indeed softened toward her for a moment.

Just for a moment.

In the empty room, there was only President Yan's breathing, eerily quiet.

Footnotes:

¹ **"Be good" (聽話):** This phrase in Chinese carries a tender, affectionate tone typically used when comforting someone close to you—like a parent to a child, or between intimate partners. Yin Lingzhu's unconscious use of this phrase reveals her deeper feelings despite trying to maintain distance.

² **Fold-eared cat:** Scottish Fold cats are known for their distinctive folded ears but often have health problems due to genetic issues. This reference connects to the cat that President Yan had given to Yin Lingzhu during their marriage, which later died in a car accident involving President Yan—a painful memory that adds layers to this seemingly innocent comparison.